

CIC 34

Community Interest Company Report

For official use
(Please leave blank)

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*Please
complete in
typescript, or
in bold black
capitals.*

Company Name in
full

FRIENDS OF PARKINSON'S PARK CIC

Company Number

10044868

Year Ending

31 MARCH 2022

PART 1 - GENERAL DESCRIPTION OF THE COMPANY'S ACTIVITIES AND IMPACT

Please insert a general account of the company's activities in the financial year to which the report relates, including a description of how they have benefited the community.

For the first part of this Financial Year England was still in a 'lockdown' situation and our activity was restricted. The Park continued to provide a valued green space for recreation and general wellbeing whilst the Friends offered a range of permitted community activities. November 2021 saw the 10th anniversary of the founding of Friends of Parkinson's Park in 2011 – a number of the original committee are still either Directors of FOPP CIC or members.

1. FACILITATE A PROGRAMME OF EVENTS TO GENERATE COMMUNITY SPIRIT.

As with the previous financial year, many of our usual events were restricted due to Government public health regulations on gatherings and lockdown. FOPP therefore continued with a programme of flexible, events that could be done by families under regulations current at any one time. The objective was to improve physical and mental health by generating a feeling of social connection and community spirit at a difficult time:

- Building on our experience from 2020, several seasonal children's trails were held including Easter Bunny, a Space Trail for the Children's Gala, and a Christmas Tree Trail. These proved extremely popular with families who could do the trails in their own time. As in the previous year, the Christmas Trail was put together by a range of local residents creating different installations.
- By December restrictions had eased, and despite concerns about whether lockdown would be brought back, the traditional annual Lantern Parade eventually took place and was much enjoyed as people could again get together to celebrate the season.
- FOPP's programme of events linked to the seasons continued. In addition to those mentioned elsewhere, picnics were encouraged during National Picnic Week, and a litter pick organized for the Annual National Spring Clean. When the Duke of Edinburgh died in April 2021, the Jubilee Tree was used for people to tie mourning ribbons or leave flowers.
- The Park continued to be used by groups as an outdoor venue, subject to relevant restrictions at the time. Guiseley Brass Band used the Park for rehearsals, schools used it for lessons, and uniformed groups used it to meet for nature activities eg wildflower planting. Another successful 'Day in the Woods' event was also held by an outside arts organization.
- Following the encouragement of community art in the Park the previous year, a programme of seasonal Yarn Bombing was put together. Local residents and park users were encouraged to provide crochet or knitted items for Easter, the Summer Season, Remembrance, Christmas and Valentines Week. The main co-ordinating artist for this went on to be chosen as the lead artist for a Leeds 2023 yarn bombing project. Called "Yarns Well Spun" the project was tailored to our areas' historic link to textiles. Many of the participants who had been encouraged to take part in the Park displays went on to help create displays across the whole Township.

2. IMPROVE KNOWLEDGE AND ENJOYMENT OF THE AREA AND ITS HERITAGE.

We have always made improvements to the Park's ecological habitats in conjunction with community organizations and this continued in the 2021/22 financial year – covid restrictions allowing. As in the previous year involving people in nature helped relieve stress with positive action.

- Work continued on developing areas of the park on an individual or small group basis eg the wild flower area, the orchard, bog garden and the entrance gates. Three gates received particular attention from work-parties, Open Country and our placement student – Hillside, Nethercliffe and Greenshaw. Our policy of different people taking responsibility for different areas meant that this worked well.
- We regularly posted information on the historical aspects of the Park and wildlife to spot, count and nurture. We encouraged people to take part in nature events such as the Big Garden Birdwatch, spring Blossom Season, and the summer Butterfly count. We held a spring Dawn Chorus

Walk, and an autumn Apple Day, which allows people to juice apples that, would otherwise go to waste and learn more about orchards and their produce – orchards are a priority habitat. Also in the autumn bulbs, given by outside organizations eg RHS, were distributed to local residents, especially children, to plant in their favourite spot in the Park.

- Local schools use the Park and information provided for history lessons. In the Autumn we gave the Orchard a name to reflect the Anglo Saxon history of the area and erected a new sign.

3. IMPROVE PARK FACILITIES IN COLLABORATION WITH OTHER GROUPS. CONTINUE TO ENSURE SAFETY AND ACCESSIBILITY :

- An unsafe dry stone wall was mended by two Friends with the relevant qualifications and experience.
- Activity was undertaken with a risk assessment and when appropriate, a specific coronavirus risk assessment.
- We have taken steps to promote Leeds Park By-Laws in a 'carrot' rather than a 'stick' way. Overcoming the anti-social issues of drug taking and dog mess are two ongoing tasks.
- Individual activity to maintain a safe park eg litter picking, removing dog waste, was encouraged, especially as the numbers using the park increased. FOPP lent out our litter pickers for the task.
- Once Government regulations allowed, general park upkeep was resumed eg grass cutting , hedge trimming, and scrub.
- The use of the 'natter bench' was encouraged so that people could talk with others if they felt that would help them overcome loneliness, isolation or depression.
- We put woodchip on paths over winter to try and make them safer but the increase in park use and a wet winter meant that this was not as successful as in previous years and some areas became treacherous.

4. Resources and income streams for activity came from the following:

- Fund raising events eg Christmas Trail.
- Donations via Local Giving and a new donation box in the Park.
- We were made a Co-Op Local Cause in October 21, this scheme lasts for one year.
- Local Councillor community 'mice' money for Lantern Parade.
- Provision of bulbs to distribute from organizations such as RHS

PART 2 – CONSULTATION WITH STAKEHOLDERS - *Please indicate who the company's stakeholders are; how the stakeholders have been engaged and what action, if any, has the company taken in response to feedback from its engagement? If there has been no consultation, this should be made clear.*

FOPP Board – a new Treasurer was appointed. He was consulted over improving our accounts system, recommendations are now in the process of being implemented.

Friends – have been involved in all the activities of the Park in 2021/22. This has been on both an individual basis and on working parties. FOPP has provided the co-ordination and risk and project management.

Local Community Organizations and Representatives – FOPP has been able to provide local organizations with a venue for their activities in line with any regulations. External organizations have also supported FOPP's activities in a variety of ways and brought their own ideas to projects. This has enabled us to achieve our objectives.

Local Community – have been kept informed and engaged through a variety of media from digital to personal. We have taken part in groups dedicated to supporting community organizations such as ourselves.

Meadfleet (land managers) – We have regular discussions and consult with the relevant area and regional managers at Meadfleet.

Leeds City Council (LCC)– FOPP keeps regular contact with our ward Councillors who support our activities. We are also members of Leeds Parks Forum which is organized by LCC. The Park is now officially recognized in the Leeds Local Plan – Strategic Green Infrastructure, as both a Natural Area and a Community Park. We take part in relevant Local Plan consultations.

(If applicable, please just state "A social audit report covering these points is attached").

PART 3 – DIRECTORS' REMUNERATION – *if you have provided full details in your accounts you need not reproduce it here. Please clearly identify the information within the accounts and confirm that, "There were no other transactions or arrangements in connection with the remuneration of directors, or compensation for director's loss of office, which require to be disclosed" (See example with full notes). If no remuneration was received you must state that "no remuneration was received" below.*

No remuneration has been received by any of the Directors.

PART 4 – TRANSFERS OF ASSETS OTHER THAN FOR FULL CONSIDERATION – *Please insert full details of any transfers of assets other than for full consideration e.g. Donations to outside bodies. If this does not apply you must state that “no transfer of assets other than for full consideration has been made” below.*

No transfer of assets of any kind has occurred

(Please continue on separate continuation sheet if necessary.)

PART 5 – SIGNATORY

The original report must be signed by a director or secretary of the company

Signed

Jennifer A Kirkby

Date

14 November
2022

*Office held - **Director***

You do not have to give any contact information in the box opposite but if you do, it will help the Registrar of Companies to contact you if there is a query on the form. The contact information that you give will be visible to searchers of the public record.

2 The Sycamores, Guiseley	
West Yorkshire	
LS20 9EN	
Tel 01943 877360	
DX Number	DX Exchange

When you have completed and signed the form, please attach it to the accounts and send both forms by post to the Registrar of Companies at:

For companies registered in England and Wales: Companies House, Crown Way, Cardiff, CF14 3UZ
DX 33050 Cardiff

For companies registered in Scotland: Companies House, 4th Floor, Edinburgh Quay 2, 139
Fountainbridge, Edinburgh, EH3 9FF DX 235 Edinburgh or LP – 4 Edinburgh 2

For companies registered in Northern Ireland: Companies House, 2nd Floor, The Linenhall, 32-38
Linenhall Street, Belfast, BT2 8BG

(N.B. Please enclose a cheque for £15 payable to Companies House)